

B-TRACE User Guide

B-TRACE (Birth Tracking for Registration and Certificate Entries) is a desktop/web application for the City Civil Registry Office (CCRO). It helps staff track delayed birth registration applicants, manage document requirements by age and situation, fill official forms, and generate printable PDFs.

For a shorter technical walkthrough, see [Demo.md](#). For installation and development, see [trace-app/README.md](#).

PDF: [USER_GUIDE.pdf](#) - regenerate anytime from the trace-app folder:

```
npm run export:user-guide-pdf
```

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1. Getting started

Sign in

1. Open the application (browser in development, or the packaged Electron desktop app).
2. On the Login screen, enter your username and password.
3. Click Login. Invalid credentials show an error; successful login takes you to the Dashboard.

Sign out

Use Logout at the bottom of the left sidebar. You return to the login page.

2. Main navigation (left sidebar)

Menu item	Purpose
Dashboard	Overview, charts, recent applicants, database backup
Applicants	Standard delayed registration records
COLB BRAP	Separate workflow for COLB BRAP records (simpler
Logout	End session

The header shows B-TRACE and the tag Document Requirements, reflecting that document completeness is the core of the system.

3. Dashboard

After login you see:

- Totals - How many applicants exist and how many are Verified vs still pending.
- Charts
- Applicants by age group - Registration status (Incomplete Checklist, Under Process, Verified) - Applications over time (filter: last 7/14 days, 12 months, year, or custom range)
- Recent applicants - Quick links to open a profile.
- Add applicant - Opens the same add form as on the Applicants list.
- Export Backup / Import Backup - Download or restore a .zip containing the database and all attachments (for moving data between machines or disaster recovery).

4. Applicants list

Open Applicants from the sidebar.

Find and filter

- Search - By name, place of birth, or date of birth (several date formats work).
- Status filters - All, Incomplete Checklist, Under Process, Verified.

Each row shows:

- Name (LAST, FIRST format on the list)
- Date of birth
- Document progress (X/Y complete) or - if the checklist was never opened
- Status badge (color-coded)

Click a row to open that person's profile.

Add a new applicant

1. Click Add applicant.
2. Fill Basic details (required: first name, last name, date of birth).
3. Under Conditional document requirements, check everything that applies (see Section 16). These add extra

checklist items automatically.

4. Click Add applicant. You are taken to the new profile.

Place of birth (when adding or editing)

Enter place of birth as three parts separated by two commas:

Hospital or address, City, Province

Example: Connelly - Cummings Clinic, Calamba, Lanao Del Norte

This helps the Certificate of Live Birth form split the address, city, and municipality/province automatically. If you use only one comma (city and province only), the COLB form may not fill city and province fields - you should enter the full three-part format when possible.

5. Applicant profile

The profile header shows the name in LAST, FIRST form (e.g. RODRIGUEZ, NORMA KENJI).

Action buttons (top row)

Button	What it does
Certificate of Live Birth (green)	Official COLB data entry form
Document checklist	Required documents, uploads, camera capture
Paternity Affidavit	Paternity affidavit form
Delayed Birth Affidavit	Delayed registration affidavit
AUSF (Adult) / AUSF (0-6) / AUSF (7-17)	Affidavit to Use Surname of the Father - label depends on
Print certification	Delayed registration certification letter/PDF
Front PDF	Generate/preview front of combined COLB + checklist PDF
Back PDF	Generate/preview back (affidavits, etc.)
Edit	Update applicant details and conditional flags
Delete	Remove the record (confirmation required)

Front PDF and Back PDF - After the document checklist is 100% complete (every required item has at least one attachment), click these buttons to open options to print/preview or save the front and back pages of the generated Certificate of Live Birth PDF.

Button	Menu options
Front PDF	Print Front (preview in browser) Save Front as PDF
Back PDF	Print Back (preview) Save Back as PDF (desktop app)

Note: Front PDF and Back PDF stay disabled (grayed out) until the checklist is fully complete. They do not require staff to mark the case Under Process or Verified - only completed document attachments. The tooltip says: Complete the document checklist first.

To change the applicant's name, date of birth, contact, or conditional flags, use Edit on this profile - not the certification letter screen.

Status banner

Below the buttons:

- Status badge - e.g. Incomplete Checklist (amber).
- Message: Complete every checklist item to enable Under Process and Verified.

When the checklist is 100% complete:

- Mark Under Process and Mark Verified appear.
- Staff can move the case through internal processing.

Important: On the Document checklist page, if you have unsaved edits, you must wait for auto-save (about 1.5 seconds after you stop editing) before staff status buttons work. The message then says: Save the checklist before setting Under Process or Verified.

Child identification section

Displays:

- Full name, date of birth (DD-MM-YYYY), age, gender
- Place of birth, contact number (see Place of birth format above)
- Age group (requirements) - e.g. 18 to 59 (drives which documents are required); not shown for COLB BRAP records
- Conditional requirements - If any were set at add/edit (deceased registrant, foreign parent, out-of-town, etc.)
- Created / Updated dates
- Documents checklist - Progress bar or link Open document checklist to get started

Adult delayed registrations (e.g. age group 18 to 59) use age-specific items such as baptismal, school records, voter's certification, NBI/police clearance, plus general items (National ID, PSA Negative, affidavits, barangay certifications, 2x2 photo).

6. Application status workflow

Statuses work in this order:

```
Status flow:
Incomplete Checklist
-> Checklist 100% complete
-> Mark Under Process
-> Mark Verified
```

Status	Meaning
Incomplete Checklist	One or more required documents not yet attached/checked
Under Process	Checklist complete; staff marked the case in progress
Verified	Checklist complete; staff marked the case verified

Checklist completion is automatic: each requirement is "done" when it has at least one attachment (upload or camera). You do not manually tick checkboxes - they reflect attachments.

7. Document checklist (core workflow)

Open via Document checklist on the profile or the green link under Documents checklist.

Structure

Requirements are grouped into steps (when applicable):

1. General documents - Same for all applicants (National ID, PSA Negative, affidavits, barangay certifications, 2x2 photo, etc.)
2. Age-specific requirements - Based on age group:
 - 1 month 1 day to 6 years - 7 to 17 years - 18 to 59 years - 60 plus
1. Conditional documents - Only if flags were set (death certificates, foreign parent ID, out-of-town affidavit, marriage contract vs AUSF, etc.)

Per requirement you can

- Add Notes (optional)
- Attach file(s) from the computer
- Take Picture - For the 2x2 photo ID (crop overlay, white background)
- Scan Document - For other items (document-oriented crop)
- View / Remove attachments (remove asks for confirmation)

Saving

- Changes auto-save about 1.5 seconds after you stop editing.
- Leaving the page with unsaved changes triggers a navigation warning.
- Progress bar at top shows % complete.

Marriage / AUSF on checklist

- If parents are married (marriage contract on file), the checklist expects Marriage contract instead of AUSF.
- The profile's AUSF button is hidden when married; use marriage contract on the checklist instead.

8. Certificate of Live Birth (COLB)

1. Click Certificate of Live Birth (green).
2. Enter all fields matching the official Municipal Form No. 102 layout (child, parents, birth facts, attendant, etc.).
3. Save the form. Data is stored on the applicant record.

Many other outputs (AUSF, Front/Back PDF, certification) pull data from this form. If COLB is empty, AUSF print may show an error to complete COLB first.

9. Affidavits and certification

Paternity Affidavit

Separate form for acknowledgment/admission of paternity. Fill, save, and use with back PDF mapping where applicable.

Delayed Birth Affidavit

Affidavit for delayed registration of birth. Fill and save; fields can appear on the back PDF.

AUSF (Affidavit to Use Surname of the Father)

- Shown only when parents are not marked as married.
- Variant by age:
 - AUSF (0-6) - Child 0-6 - AUSF (7-17) - Minor 7-17 - AUSF (Adult) - 18+
- Requires saved Certificate of Live Birth data.
- Choose paper size (Long or A4), preview, save PDF (desktop can open in Edge/Chrome).

Print certification

Generates the Delayed Registration of Birth certification letter. Open it from Print certification on the applicant or COLB BRAP profile.

On the letter preview:

- Click to edit request person - Click the name in "issued upon the request of ..." to type who requested the certification. Press Enter or click outside the field when finished.
- Click to edit certification purpose - Click the purpose text (e.g. ANY LEGAL) in "for ... requirement purposes" to change it. Press Enter or click outside when finished.
- Signatory - Choose from the dropdown (city civil registrar or registration officers).
- Changes save automatically (about one second after you stop editing) to the Certificate of Live Birth record.
- Preview or Save as PDF - Long or A4 paper size (save requires the desktop/Electron app).

Note: To edit the applicant's profile (legal name, birth date, etc.), use Edit on the profile page - not these click-to-edit fields on the certification letter.

10. Front PDF and Back PDF

Available on the applicant or COLB BRAP profile only when the document checklist is 100% complete.

Front PDF

- Combines Certificate of Live Birth field positions with the Document Requirements Checklist on the official front layout.
- Click Front PDF -> Print Front (browser preview) or Save Front as PDF (saves to disk in the desktop app; you can open it in Edge or Chrome).

Back PDF

- Maps Paternity Affidavit, Delayed Registration Affidavit, and related marks to the back of the form.
- Click Back PDF -> Print Back or Save Back as PDF.

Both require a complete checklist (every line has an attachment) and a filled Certificate of Live Birth (and related affidavits where used). Staff Verified status is not required to enable these buttons.

11. Edit and delete

Edit

- Updates name, DOB, contact, place of birth, and conditional requirement checkboxes.
- Changing conditions updates the checklist (new items may appear; removed conditions may drop items - confirm current attachments after edits).

Delete

- Opens a confirmation dialog.
 - Permanent - removes applicant, checklist, attachments, and related saved form data from the local database.
-

12. COLB BRAP (separate menu)

COLB BRAP is a separate registration track. Use the COLB BRAP item in the sidebar - not Applicants - for these records.

How it differs from Applicants

Topic	Applicants	COLB BRAP
Checklist	General + age-specific + conditionals	5 general items + up to 3 conditionals
Age group	Used for extra documents	Not used
Add/Edit flags	Out of town, deceased registrant,	Parents married, child registrant,
Front / Back PDF	Enabled when checklist 100% complete	Same rule - not tied to staff Verified
Place of birth	Three-part comma format (see Section	Same format

Add a COLB BRAP record

1. Open COLB BRAP -> Add COLB BRAP.
2. Fill basic details (name, date of birth, place of birth, contact, etc.).
3. Under COLB BRAP conditional requirement, check all that apply (see COLB BRAP flags in Section 16).
4. Save - you are taken to the COLB BRAP profile.

COLB BRAP document checklist

Always required (general):

1. National I.D.
2. Brgy. indigency
3. Affidavit of Two Witnesses (Legal Office)
4. Brgy. Certification (Facts of Birth)
5. 2x2 Photo I.D. with white background

Conditional (from add/edit flags):

- Parents are married -> Marriage certificate on checklist (AUSF not used).
- Parents not married -> AUSF on checklist; profile may show AUSF by age.
- Registrant is a child -> Valid I.D. of parent/s or guardian.
- Muslim registrant -> Muslim attachment.

The checklist has no age-specific step - only general and conditional groups. Progress, attachments, and auto-save work the same as for Applicants.

COLB BRAP profile

Same action buttons as a standard applicant profile: Certificate of Live Birth, Document checklist, affidavits, Print certification, Front PDF, Back PDF, Edit, Delete.

- Front PDF / Back PDF - Same as Section 10: enabled only when every checklist item has an attachment; use Print or Save as PDF from the dialog. Not blocked by staff Verified status.
 - Place of birth - Use Hospital or address, City, Province with two commas when entering on add/edit.
- Use Applicants for standard delayed registration only; use COLB BRAP for BRAP program records.

13. Backup and restore

On the Dashboard:

1. Export Backup - Downloads a .zip with trace.db and all attachment files.
2. Import Backup - Upload a previously exported .zip; merges records and attachments without wiping unrelated data when possible.

Use this for:

- Moving data from a field laptop to the main office
- Scheduled backups
- Recovery after hardware failure

14. Recommended daily workflow

Standard Applicants (delayed registration)

1. Add applicant - Use three-part place of birth (address, city, province) when possible.
2. Open document checklist -> Complete every general, age-specific, and conditional item with uploads or scans.
3. Wait for auto-save; confirm progress shows 100%.
4. On profile, click Mark Under Process when intake review starts.
5. Complete Certificate of Live Birth and affidavits as needed.
6. Use AUSF (correct age variant) if parents are not married.
7. Front PDF / Back PDF -> Print or Save as PDF (buttons enabled after checklist is complete).
8. Print certification -> click to edit request person and purpose on the letter if needed; preview or save PDF.
9. Mark Verified when the case is fully processed.

COLB BRAP

1. COLB BRAP -> Add COLB BRAP -> set conditional flags -> complete the shorter checklist (no age-specific step).
2. Certificate of Live Birth and affidavits as needed.
3. When checklist is 100%, use Front PDF / Back PDF and Print certification (same rules as above).
4. Mark Under Process / Mark Verified when appropriate.

15. Tips and troubleshooting

Issue	What to check
Front/Back PDF disabled	Finish every checklist item (attachments on each line); staff
Status stuck at Incomplete Checklist	All items have attachments; then use Mark Under Process
COLB city/province empty	Use place of birth with two commas: address, city, province
AUSF button missing	Parents marked married - use marriage contract on checklist
AUSF won't print	Save Certificate of Live Birth first
Can't mark Verified on checklist page	Wait for auto-save to finish (~1.5 s after last edit)
Wrong documents listed	Edit applicant - verify date of birth and conditional
BRAP case in wrong list	Open COLB BRAP, not Applicants
Certification name/purpose won't change	Click the bold text on the letter (request person / purpose),
Save certification PDF fails	Use the desktop (Electron) app
Data on another PC	Export backup on source; import on destination

16. Age groups and conditional flags (reference)

Age groups (from date of birth)

Age group	Approximate ages
1m1d to 6	Infant / young child
7 to 17	Minor
18 to 59	Adult
60 plus	Senior

Conditional flags when adding/editing applicants

Flag	Adds to checklist
Out of town	Affidavit w/ Corroboration (Legal Office)
Registrant deceased	Death certificate (registrant)
One parent foreigner	Passport or BI certificate
HILOT deceased (age <=5)	Death certificate (HILOT)

COLB BRAP only

Flag	Adds to checklist
Parents are married	Marriage contract
Registrant is a child	Valid I.D. of parent/s or guardian
Muslim registrant	Muslim attachment

When parents are not married on a COLB BRAP record, AUSF is required instead of marriage contract.

Document version: aligned with Trace-App-CCRO as of May 2026.